

ALUMNI STORY

FROM CLEC LEARNING TO NEW POSSIBILITIES



Ayush Rajbanshi is a former student of Shree Sarvajani Secondary School, Biratnagar, where the Collaborative Learning Environment Center (CLEC) has created new opportunities for students to learn through technology and collaboration.

During his school years, Ayush regularly used the CLEC to support his studies and homework. Access to computers and digital learning resources gave him an opportunity to explore information beyond the traditional classroom and develop greater confidence in using technology for learning.

For Ayush, the CLEC was more than a computer room. It became a space where he could research, complete assignments, and learn with the support of digital resources. Experiences like these helped him become more comfortable with technology and opened his mind to new possibilities for the future.

Now, Ayush is continuing his education in Grade 11 at City College. His journey reflects how access to technology during school years can continue to influence students as they move into higher education and explore new interests and career opportunities.

Today, Ayush is interested in video editing, reflecting the growing ways young people can use digital skills creatively and professionally.

The CLEC at Shree Sarvajani Secondary School was established in 2023 through collaboration between Digital Bridges for Nepal (DB4N), Build Better Biratnagar, and Biratnagar Metropolitan City, and was upgraded in 2025 into a Collaborative Learning Environment Center. The center aims to strengthen digital literacy, collaborative learning, critical thinking, and student-centered education.

Ayush's journey is one example of how creating access to technology in public schools can give students the tools, confidence, and exposure to explore new opportunities beyond the classroom.

FROM STRUGGLE TO LEADERSHIP — A MOTIVATIONAL JOURNEY OF BHAGWAN SHAKYA

In the hills of Gorkha, inside Shree Sanskrit Secondary School, stands a man whose journey reflects resilience, sacrifice, and hope—Bhagwan Shakya, the Principal.

Today, he sits proudly in a modern CLEC room, surrounded by technology, students, and new possibilities. But his story did not begin here. It began in struggle.

As a young student, he was among the top performers in his class at school. He had dreams, ambition, and a deep hunger to learn. But dreams alone were not enough in those days. There were no computers, no internet, and very limited learning resources. Even a simple calculator was a luxury. Education was confined to textbooks, and opportunities were scarce.

Despite his talent, life after SLC took a difficult turn. Family challenges forced him to leave home and move to Kathmandu with a friend. For a short time, he had shelter—but soon, he was on his own.

To survive, he worked as a security guard for nearly eight years. Eight years of long nights. Eight years of uncertainty. Eight years of standing guard while silently holding on to a dream of becoming something more.



Behind his struggle was another silent force—his mother. She worked tirelessly, carrying the weight of sacrifice and hope, believing her son would one day rise above hardship.

And he did.

Through determination, patience, and unwavering belief in education, he was finally selected through the Public Service Commission as a teacher. That moment was not just a job—it was a transformation of his life.

Today, he stands as the Principal of Shree Sanskrit Secondary School.

When he looks at the CLEC room, he does not just see computers and technology. He sees a second chance—not for himself, but for every student who sits where he once dreamed.

He believes this space will change lives. Students who once struggled with limited resources will now learn through collaboration, technology, and creativity. They will gain skills he never had access to, but always wished for.

And that is what makes his journey powerful.

From a boy who studied without resources...
To a security guard who protected buildings while dreaming of classrooms...
To a leader shaping the future of rural education...

His story carries one message:

Your beginning does not decide your ending. Your struggle is not your limit—it is your strength in disguise.



Namaste.

At Shree Sanskrit Secondary School, he now works to ensure that no student feels left behind because of lack of opportunity. Instead, they are encouraged to dream bigger, learn deeper, and rise higher.

Because if one journey can rise from silence to leadership, so can many others.



A PARENT'S ROLE IN KEEPING CHILDREN SAFE ONLINE

As children spend more time learning, communicating, and exploring online, parents play an important role in helping them navigate the digital world safely.

For Kopila Adhikari, a parent from Dhawa, Belkotgadhi-4, a recent Digital Safety Awareness Session organized by DB4N offered practical ideas she could take home and use with her child, who studies at Shree Pravat Secondary School.

The session encouraged parents to look beyond simply limiting screen time and instead build open communication with their children. Kopila learned about setting healthy digital routines, encouraging age-appropriate content, staying connected with teachers, and helping children recognize the risks of interacting with strangers or downloading unsafe apps and games.

"I learned many useful things today. We should ask children to stop using their mobile phones at least one hour before bedtime. We also learned to talk openly with our children, stay in contact with teachers, make sure they only use content suitable for their age, and prevent them from talking to strangers online."

For Kopila, the session was a reminder that keeping children safe online begins at home—with awareness, communication, and guidance.

"I am very thankful for this awareness program. I hope more programs like this will be organized in the future so that more parents can learn how to keep their children safe online."

Through initiatives like these, DB4N is helping parents become more confident digital safety partners—supporting children to use technology not only effectively, but safely and responsibly.

SUPPORT US
BY MAKING
DONATIONS.



www.digitalbridges.org

**EMPOWERING RURAL STUDENTS TODAY,
CREATING EDUCATORS & LEADERS FOR TOMORROW.**